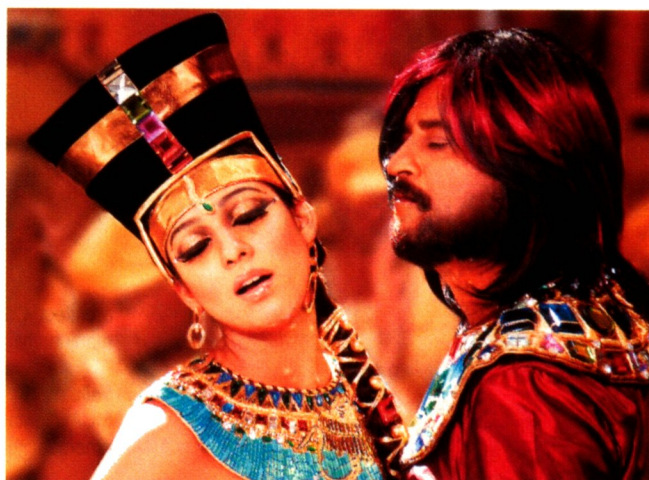


film review **Boss is Back**

KUSELAN

Director: P. Vasu
Starring: Rajnikant,
Nayantara

When intelligence speaks, wisdom listens, says Rajnikant to a non-believer in one of the many aphorisms that pepper this Tamil/Telugu film, remade from the Malayalam hit *Katha Parayumpol*. Superstardom is when Rajnikant acts. Everything is over-the-top and beyond-belief, existing to showcase the Boss to best effect. This is a story about a barber's friendship with a superstar, and how an entire village moves from disbelieving to genuflecting when his film shoot comes visiting. Rajnikant



LOVE IN NEVERLAND: Nayantara and Rajnikant

plays the superstar Ashok Kumar, who romances a sex bomb half his age and walks out of his portrait, but he may as well have played himself. The film is as much about the love for cinema (there is a super song that is an ode to 75 years of Tamil cinema) as it is about the cult of

Rajnikant. This is one canny actor who is perpetuating his myth without it seeming narcissistic. Coming soon, after Shankar's *Robot*, is an animation film that will sustain his stardom by creating an alter ego that could go on and on.

by Kaveree Bamzai

recommendations **Prose and Plays**

DELHI V. Ramesh has taken a break from his oils and worked on large format paper with gauche and watercolours. He uses metaphorical elements and fantastical imagery to depict the human body. The exploration of "self" is evident in the lines of medieval Bhakti poetry put in the

Assault by V. Ramesh



A scene from
Choudhury's *The Whale*

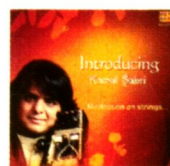
paintings. The works have poetic intensity and depth. At Gallery Threshold, from August 9 to 30.

BANGALORE One of India's best known theatre directors, Neelam Mansingh Choudhury, is coming to Bangalore with Girish Karnad's *Nagamandala* as well as her latest play *The Suit*. *Nagamandala*, created 17 years ago, has been revisited by Choudhury as she winds in elements of Punjabi folk with

live music and dance, while *The Suit* is a contemporary tale, written as a short story by acclaimed South African writer Can Themba. She brings a unique Punjabi flavour to the drama using both English and Punjabi. She uses the play as a personification of everything that is wrong with our system. There is much to interpret from Choudhury's version. At Ranga Shankara, from August 12 to 15.

by Nirmala Ravindran

music reviews **Pure Moods**



Sa Re Ga Ma
Rs 175

KAMAL SABRI

This pure classical album by Kamal Sabri is a surprise. In the

clutter of Indi-pop, fusion and electro-fusion, this mix album stands out, featuring raga Ahir Bhairav, Madhuvanti and Kajri Manj-khama). It is not accompanied by the tabla, which is rare. "I wanted to give the album a meditative quality. I thought it would provide a soothing effect to frayed nerves, so I did away with rhythm," says Sabri, who is the son of sarangi maestro Ustad Sabri Khan and is carrying forward the rich legacy of the Senia gharana. This is truly music with a therapeutic effect.



Devi Foundation
Rs 300

RASAN PIYA

If you want to go back to the musical grace associated

with the 1930s and '40s, get ready for the doyen of Gwalior gharana, Ustad Abdul Rashid Khan. Born in 1909, he took his initial training from his uncle Bade Yousuf Khan Saheb and then tutored under Ustad Behram Khan's traditional lineage of the Gwalior gharana. A prolific poet and lyricist, he has composed numerous khayal bandishes under the name, Rasan Piya. The 99-year-old ustad is simply delightful to listen to—his resonant voice is rich in content. He presents raga Bihag. Des, Bhopali, Lalit, Jaijhwanti and Kajri. It is a must-have for those wanting to preserve a golden period in music.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit